

ESTABLISH YOUR FINANCIAL INDEPENDENCE

I meet a lot of interesting people in television. Most of them are decent, well-intentioned men and women who are trying hard to provide for their families. But they haven't always made the best decisions. For some, one bad choice was enough to put them on the road to financial ruin.

Katrina is a 40-year-old woman who immigrated to Canada as a teenager. She is intelligent and industrious, and as she told me her story, I was shocked that someone so bright could be in such serious financial trouble—all because of one crucial mistake.

Katrina had gone to university, studied hard, and was working as a teacher when she met Raj, her husband, through an arranged match. Raj was a charismatic young man and an up-and-coming engineer. The two hit it off immediately. It took some time for Raj to pass due diligence with Katrina's family. Her mother was concerned that he was in his mid-20s and had not amassed much in the way of savings, but eventually both families gave the relationship the green light. Raj and Katrina worked hard during the first years of their marriage to save money and invest wisely. Raj handled all the family finances, and little by little, their dynasty